

Element Dynasty

Chapter 2 – The Awakening

Many years ago, something extraordinary happened on Akansh's grandfather's farm. It was a quiet night. The sky was clear, and the fields lay silent under the moonlight. Without warning, a blazing object tore across the sky and crashed into the farm with a deafening impact.

The next morning, Akansh's grandfather walked through the fields and noticed a massive crater that hadn't been there the day before. At the center of it rested a strange black box surrounded by red lines. The impact had scorched the surrounding soil, making it obvious that whatever had landed there had come from far beyond Earth. Curious yet cautious, he climbed into the crater and carefully picked up the box. It was surprisingly cold to the touch and unlike anything he had ever seen. There was no lock, no hinge, and no visible opening. He tried everything he could to open it, but it refused to budge. Over the following years, every member of the family tried. They pushed, pulled, struck, and examined it from every angle, yet the mysterious box remained completely sealed. Eventually, they accepted defeat. Believing it to be nothing more than an unsolved mystery, they placed it in the old storeroom, where it sat untouched for years... waiting. Until one ordinary day, Akansh placed his hand on its surface. With a faint glow, the impossible finally happened. The box was open. But the moment the box was finally opened, those who knew of its existence felt it. They didn't know who had opened it... only that the seal had finally been opened after millions of years.

The moment box open

On a lonely planet Gaur was sitting upon a cliff overlooking an ocean. The cold wind howled across the white landscape. Snow fell endlessly from the dark sky above. Yet Gaur remained perfectly still. Meditating. Waiting. Suddenly, for a brief moment, Gaur stood up. For the first time in many years, worry appeared on his face.

"The Elements..." he whispered. His voice disappeared into the cold wind. "It has been opened." He turned his eyes toward the endless stars above him.

After all these years... After all this waiting... It had finally come.

Without hesitation, he spoke into the empty air. "ED."

A faint blue light appeared beside him. "Get ready." His expression hardened.

That faint blue light was a cloud of shimmering blue nanoparticles gathered beside him, after taking the graceful form of a young woman. "Everything is ready, Captain," ED replied with a smile. For a few moments, Gaur's eyes fixed on the countless stars shining above the frozen planet.

"Prepare the ship." ED folded her hands behind her back.

"I already did. I knew you would say that. The ship has been ready for the last twelve years... ever since the day you began waiting here." A faint smile appeared on Gaur's face. "You still count the years?"

"I count everything," ED replied. "The signal has been confirmed. The Elemental Artifact has finally been activated... for the first time in millions of years." In a moment

Gaur took one last look at the frozen planet. That had been his home for twelve years.

Endless sheets of snow stretched beyond the horizon, untouched by time. The icy winds howled across the barren landscape, yet everything was peaceful.

Then a brilliant green beam of light suddenly descended from the sky, surrounding Gaur from head to toe.

In milliseconds, his body dissolved into countless particles and vanished. From the plane,

ED's voice echoed in the spacecraft. "Transport sequence complete. Welcome aboard, Captain." Gaur was in a spacecraft. Gaur stepped onto the command deck and walked toward the main control panel. The massive transparent screen before him came to life. He asked ED "Show me."

The lights dimmed as a three-dimensional map of the universe appeared before him. Billions of stars filled the display, while one tiny point pulsed with a bright golden circle. ED materialized beside the console as a cloud of blue nanoparticles. "Target located," she said. "Designation: CG-0.7."

Gaur chuckled. "So... the Baby Planet."

"There are over seven thousand billion inhabited planets within the known universe," ED replied. "Referring to one of them as 'Baby Planet' is statistically inefficient."

Gaur crossed his arms with a smile. "You and your classifications."

He looked at the glowing point on the map.

"They haven't achieved interstellar travel... they aren't united under a single planetary government... and they haven't mastered stable energy systems. By our standards, they're still a civilization in its infancy."

He smiled again. "So... Baby Planet still suits them."

ED paused for a second before replying, "Scientifically speaking... CG-0.7 remains the correct designation."

Gaur laughed quietly. "Fine. You win this one." Then ED's expression became serious. "Captain... we are no longer the only ones aware that the Elemental Artifact has been opened. Others will have sensed it as well."

Gaur's smile faded. "I know." He fixed his eyes on the highlighted world. "Then let's not keep destiny waiting."

The engines roared to life as the spacecraft turned toward CG-0.7

Beginning a journey that would change the fate of the universe forever.

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Meanwhile, on Earth

Akansh heard that click and realized the box had finally opened. His eyes widened. Slowly, he bent down and stared at the mysterious box. "It... opened?" Unable to believe his eyes, he carefully lifted the lid.

This time, it opened without any resistance. Inside rested a beautiful green stone, glowing with a soft light. It wasn't dazzling, yet it wasn't ordinary either. The glow filled the inside of the box, making the stone seem strangely alive. Akansh couldn't take his eyes off it. "What... is this?" For a moment, he simply stared at it. Then suddenly... "Mom! Dad!" he shouted excitedly. "Come here quickly!" His voice echoed through the house. "What happened?" his father asked as he hurried toward the room. His mother followed behind him.

Akansh pointed excitedly at the box. "Look! The box finally opened!"

His parents looked at each other in surprise. "The Black box?" his father asked.

"Yes, the same box Grandpa found years ago! It finally opened!"

His father stepped forward with curiosity. "Move aside."

He reached for the lid and tried to open it. Nothing. He frowned and pulled harder. Still nothing. His mother tried next. She twisted it, pushed it, and even tried lifting it from another side.

The box remained completely sealed. Both of them looked at Akansh.

"Akansh..." his father said, "it's still closed." Akansh blinked.

"What? No... it was open! I just saw it!" His father placed the box on the table.

"See? It's still sealed," he said. Akansh shook his head. "No... it really opened." He suddenly remembered how it had happened the first time. "I didn't even pull the lid..." Both his parents looked at him with confused expressions. "I just... placed my hand on it." Akansh rested his hand on top of the mysterious box.

He waited. Nothing. He pressed his hand against it a longer. Still nothing. Silence filled the room.

His mother sighed. "See? We told you. It's just the same old box." His father nodded.

"You're probably exhausted after cleaning all morning. Get some rest."

Akansh looked down at the box. "...Maybe."

His parents smiled and walked out of the room, closing the door behind them. The room became completely silent. Akansh continued staring at the box. "It doesn't make any sense..."

He walked toward it once again. "it really opened before..."

He placed his hand on the box one more time. Then **Click**.

Akansh froze.

His eyes widened. The sound echoed through the silent room. The box had unlocked.

His heartbeat raced as he slowly lifted the lid. The glowing green stone rested inside exactly as before.

He looked toward the closed door. "They were just here..." His parents had watched him do the exact same thing.

Nothing had happened. But the moment they left... The box opened. A strange feeling crept over him.

It was almost as if... The box had been waiting until he was alone.

Akansh slowly went inside the box and picked up the glowing green stone.

It fit perfectly in the palm of his hand.

The stone felt smooth... almost polished. A coldness spread through his fingers, but apart from that, nothing seemed unusual. He turned it over. Nothing. No symbols. No hidden button. No strange markings.

Only a soft green glow. "Hmm..."

He frowned. "So much mystery... just for a glowing stone?"

Curiosity refused to leave him. He held it closer to his eyes, examining every tiny detail. Still nothing.

He even tapped it with his fingernail. The sound was exactly like an ordinary stone.

"This is disappointing." He sighed. "I thought something amazing would happen with the stone like a box

"With a small shrug, he placed the glowing stone back inside the box. The moment it touched the bottom... The green glow faded within seconds, the stone looked completely ordinary.

Akansh blinked. "Wait..." He picked it up again.

The glow returned instantly. He placed it back. The light disappeared.

He repeated it once more. Glow. Darkness. Glow. Darkness.

"Okay...." A smile appeared on his face. "So you're also interesting."

Completely unaware of what had truly happened, Akansh closed the box and slid it beneath the table. To him...

It was just a strange stone. Akansh placed the glowing stone back inside the box and closed the lid.

This time, he didn't even try to open it again. He slid the mysterious box beneath the table, making sure no one would notice it. The rest of the evening passed like any other day. Dinner with his parents. A little conversation. Nothing unusual. Yet, every few minutes, his thoughts drifted back to the strange box hidden beneath the table.

Why didn't it open in front of mom and dad? Why only for me? He had no answers. As night fell, Akansh switched off the lights and lay down on his bed. Outside, the wind whispered through the trees.

Within minutes, he drifted into a deep sleep... Completely unaware that, at that very moment,

A spacecraft was silently approaching the CG-0.7. Tomorrow would be the last ordinary day of his life.

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The next morning, sunlight streamed through Akansh's bedroom window, waking him from his sleep. For a few moments, he lay on his bed, staring at the ceiling, then he remembered. The mysterious black box. Without wasting another second, he got out of bed and looked beneath the table. The box was still there. "So... it wasn't a dream." As he got ready for college, he couldn't stop thinking about the glowing green stone. After putting on his uniform and packing his books, he pulled the box out once again and placed his hand on its surface. Click! Just as before, the box unlocked effortlessly. A smile appeared on Akansh's face.

"So it really does open only for me." He lifted the lid. The green stone was inside, glowing as if it had been waiting for him. After thinking for a moment, he picked it up and slipped it into the small front pocket of his college bag. "I'll figure out what you are later."

He closed the box, slid it back beneath the table, and zipped up his bag. Just then...

"Akansh!!!" His mother's voice echoed from the kitchen. "Hurry up! Your college bus will be there in minutes!"

"I'm coming!" Akansh replied as he hurried out of his room. After having breakfast, he picked up his bag, wore his shoes, and stood near the front door. "Bye, Mom! Bye, Dad!"

"Have you taken your tiffin," his father said with a smile.

"Yes..!" Shouts Akansh before stepping outside.

The cool morning breeze brushed against his face as he walked toward the bus stop. Within a few minutes, the college bus arrived. The doors opened, Akansh climbed aboard and walked toward the last row, where his friends usually sat. As always, Harshit was sitting by the window, half asleep. Akansh smiled.

"Some things never change."

He sat beside Harshit while Neha and Ahaana occupied the seats across from them.

The bus pulled away from the stop. Throughout the journey

As the bus continued along the road, most of the students had become quiet. The morning sunlight streamed through the windows as the hum of the engine filled the bus. Harshit was still fast asleep beside Akansh, while Ahaana sat across from them, reading a book. Akansh rested his head against the seat and looked out of the window. As the bus passed through the busy streets, his eyes landed on a large advertisement board that read, "Find Your Love, Only at MyLove." A small smile appeared on his face before he instinctively turned his gaze toward Neha. She was sitting by the window, wearing a warm woollen sweater. The collar was pulled up, covering almost half of her face as she occasionally sneezed. Her cheeks had turned slightly pink from the cold morning air. She rested her head against the window, and her eyelids slowly began to close.

Akansh watched her for a moment before noticing something.

The window beside Neha was slightly open. A cold breeze drifted through the narrow gap, brushing against her face and making a few strands of her hair sway. Still half asleep, Neha frowned and instinctively reached toward the window without opening her eyes. Her fingers searched for the handle. She stretched a little farther. Then a little more. But the handle was on the other side of the window, just beyond her reach.

She tried again. And again. But every attempt failed.

Without saying a word, Akansh stood up from his seat. Leaning slightly across the aisle, he reached over and slid the window shut. The cold breeze disappeared instantly.

Neha's expression softened almost immediately. She let out a quiet sigh of relief without even opening her eyes.

A faint smile appeared on Akansh's face. But inner thoughts

"She's wearing a sweater... Is she sick? Should I ask if she's okay?" he wondered. He thought about it for a moment. "No... maybe later."

Just then, Ahaana was looking at him over the top of her book. For a brief second, their eyes met.

Akansh immediately cleared his throat, returned to his seat, and looked back out of the window as if nothing had happened. A few moments later, curiosity got the better of him.

He glanced toward Neha once again. She had already fallen asleep peacefully, completely unaware that Akansh had quietly helped her,

After a few moments as the college comes closer Akansh remembers something. He wanted to tell Harshit about the mysterious stone. But every time he looked at him,

Harshit was either yawning or struggling to keep his eyes open. "Forget it," Akansh thought. "I'll tell him later."

A short while later, the bus entered the college campus. Akansh nudged Harshit. "Wake up, sleepyhead. We're here." Harshit opened one eye. "Already...?" Akansh laughed. "Yes..." The four friends stepped off the bus and began walking toward the college building. On the way, Samar was walking toward them with a notebook in his hand. "Harshit!" Samar called out. "Did you finish yesterday's Physics homework?" Harshit nodded. "Yeah."

Samar's face lit up. "Great! Then lend it to me. I'll copy it and give it back before class." Harshit sighed with a smile. "You say that every time." "I know," Samar laughed. "But this time I promise." "Fine," Harshit replied.

"I'll give it to you once we reach the classroom. Just make sure I get it back before the Physics lecture."

"You have my word." The five friends continued walking together toward their classroom, completely unaware that someone from another world had already arrived on Earth... and was searching for one of them.

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The five friends finally reached their classroom. As promised, Harshit took out his Physics notebook and handed it to Samar. "Here," Harshit said. "Just don't forget to return it before the Physics lecture." Samar grinned. "Relax. I'll give it back before the sir even enters the classroom." The morning classes began as usual. One lecture followed another, and before they knew it, it was time for the next period. However, just as everyone settled into their seats, the class representative entered with a smile. "Good news! Physics Sir is absent today."

A loud cheer erupted from every corner of the room. "Yesss!" "Finally!" "We got a free game period!"

Within moments, everyone rushed out of the classroom toward the games room.

Akansh, Harshit, Neha, Ahaana, and Samar walked together, laughing and talking along the way. Inside the games room, some students started playing table tennis, others picked up badminton rackets, while a few gathered around the carrom boards. Akansh looked toward Neha with a small smile. "Chess?"

Neha smiled back. "Again? You know you're going to lose."

Akansh laughed. "I know... but I'll still try." The two sat across from each other began their game.

To anyone watching, it looked like Akansh was trying his best to win. But the truth was... Winning had never been his goal. He simply enjoyed spending time with Neha. Every move, every conversation, every smile she gave him was worth far more than winning a game of chess. As expected... "Checkmate," Neha said with a proud smile.

Akansh looked at the board, sighed dramatically, and laughed. "I lost... again." "I told you," Neha teased.

"Fine, my Day will come."

As Akansh was putting the chess pieces back into the box, he suddenly remembered something.

"Oh... I almost forgot." He opened the front pocket of his college bag and took out the glowing green stone.

Neha's eyes widened slightly. "What's that?" "I found it yesterday." He placed it in her hand.

The soft green glow reflected in Neha's eyes as she examined it carefully. "It's beautiful..." she whispered.

After a few seconds, she looked back at Akansh. "It's a little cold." Just then,

Harshit and Samar noticed the glowing stone and walked over. "What are you guys looking at?" Harshit asked.

Without saying a word, Neha handed him the stone. Harshit turned it over in his hand. "Whoa... this is actually glowing." Ahaana, who had been sitting nearby Neha, leaned closer with curiosity.

"Let me see." Harshit passed it to her.

She examined it carefully from every angle before handing it to Samar.

The moment Samar held it, his eyes lit up. "Wow, Akansh! Where did you get a glowing stone like this?"

Akansh smiled. "It's a long story." Curious, all four of them gathered around him.

Akansh told them everything from the mysterious black box his grandfather had found years ago, to how no one in the family had ever been able to open it... and how, somehow, it had opened only for him. For a few moments, no one spoke. Harshit broke the silence first.

"Are you joking?" Akansh nodded. "I'm not joking." Neha looked back at the stone in disbelief. "So... it only opens for you?" "I don't know why," Akansh admitted. "Even Mom and Dad couldn't open it." Samar scratched his head.

"I can't believe it," Akansh replied "Maybe you should come to my house and see it with your own eyes"

Akansh looked at the glowing stone once again. Before anyone could say another word...Ring... Ring...

The college bell echoed through the corridor. The free period was over. "Come on," Harshit said as he stretched.

"Back to reality." Akansh placed the glowing stone back into his bag, and the five friends returned to their classroom,

Completely unaware that each of them had just touched something that would change all of their lives.

Far above the clouds of CG-0.7, Gaur's spacecraft remained hidden in orbit, invisible to every satellite

and a telescope on the planet. Inside the command deck, countless holographic screens floated in the air.

Maps, languages, history, cultures, clothing styles, transportation systems, and even live broadcasts from around

The world flashed across them at incredible speed. ED stood at the center of the room, her body formed from

billions of shimmering blue nanoparticles. Streams of data flowed around her like rivers of light.

"Captain," she said, "I have completed my preliminary analysis of CG-0.7."

Gaur folded his arms. "Report."

"Current civilization grade: 0.7." "Civilizations: One." "Dominant intelligent species: Humans." "Total active spoken

languages: More than seven thousand." "Average lifespan: Approximately seventy-three years." "Interstellar

capability: None." "Planetary government: None." "Primary method of conflict resolution..." ED paused for a

moment. "...War." Gaur closed his eyes.. "So... they still haven't learned."

"They are improving," ED replied. "Although slowly." Another holographic screen appeared before them. Images

of people wearing different styles of clothing flashed by. ED continued, "I have analyzed over two hundred million

public records. I can accurately replicate regional languages, accents, customs, greetings, and clothing."

Gaur smiled. "Show me." Instantly, ED changed her appearance. Traditional Indian clothing. A business suit.

A college student's uniform. Casual modern clothes. Within seconds, she had demonstrated dozens of different

styles. Gaur laughed. "I think you've overprepared." "I disagree," ED replied without changing her expression.

"Humans judge one another within seconds of first contact. Clothing significantly affects initial trust."

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Gaur nodded. "Fair point." Another holographic window appeared. A blinking green point pulsed on the map of CG-0.7. "The Elemental Artifact has remained stationary for the last six hours," ED reported. "So... he's home." "Correct." Gaur looked at the glowing point for a long moment. "The boy has no idea what he's carrying."

"No," ED replied. "According to my analysis, he believes it is nothing more than an unusual stone."

Gaur smiled. "Just as I expected." With a wave of his hand, the holographic map disappeared.

"So... how do I look?" Instantly, another holographic screen appeared before him, displaying his reflection.

He was still wearing the ceremonial robes of the Elements Dynasty.

ED looked at him for a moment before speaking. "I would strongly advise against wearing those on CG-0.7."

"And why is that?" "They would attract unnecessary attention."

Gaur looked at his robes and nodded. "Good point"

Hundreds of different outfits appeared before him: formal suits, traditional clothing from different cultures, casual modern wear, jackets, sweaters, and countless other styles. Gaur examined them one by one.

"So many choices..."

"They represent only 0.00003% of the clothing currently worn on Earth," ED replied.

Gaur chuckled. "I think that's more than enough." After a few moments, his eyes stopped on a simple outfit.

A plain white full-sleeved shirt. A dark brown overcoat. Black trousers. Simple leather shoes.

"No unnecessary attention," Gaur said. "A practical choice," ED agreed. Within seconds, billions of blue nanoparticles surrounded Gaur, replacing his ancient robes with the selected clothing. He looked at himself once again. "I suppose I'll blend in." ED tilted her head slightly. "There is still one problem." Gaur raised an eyebrow.

"What now?" "You are approximately six thousand years behind in human greetings."

A faint smile appeared on Gaur's face. "I'll manage." ED projected several greetings into the air

Hello. Good evening. Nice to meet you. Gaur read them before laughing.

"So many words... for saying hello." "They are considered polite." "I'll remember."

ED's expression became serious once again.

"The transport beam is ready, Captain." Gaur turned toward the enormous window overlooking the blue planet.

Earth. Or, as he preferred to call it... The Baby Planet. He took a slow breath.

"Twelve years..." He stepped onto the circular platform. A brilliant green beam surrounded him.

"Captain," ED said. "Good luck." Gaur smiled. "I have a feeling..." He looked at the blue world one last time.

"...this planet is about to change." The green light grew brighter. Within a fraction of a second, Gaur dissolved into countless particles and vanished. The command deck became silent. Only ED remained, watching the blue planet below. "Transport successful," she whispered.

On Earth Gaur "Welcome me..... Baby Planet."

And for Akansh the rest of the day passed like any other. After college, Akansh returned home, completed his homework, and spent some time with his parents. Everything seemed perfectly normal. Yet, every now and then, his thoughts wandered back to the mysterious green stone hidden beneath the table. That evening, the three of them sat together for dinner. His mother noticed that Akansh had barely touched his food.

"What happened?" she asked. "You've been unusually quiet since yesterday."

Akansh smiled. "Nothing, Mom. Just thinking about college." His parents looked at each other but didn't say anything. After dinner, Akansh's father stood up and began clearing the table.

His mother looked at Akansh's father with a smile. "Honey, could you wash the plates today? I still have some office work to finish." His father smiled back. "Looks like I don't have much of a choice."

She folded her arms with a mischievous grin.

"You don't. Besides... you're the one who gave me tomorrow's deadline."

He laughed and shook his head. "That's true." "Now go and finish your work. Here, I'm the boss," she teased.

His father sighed dramatically and gave a playful salute. "Yes, ma'am." Watching the two of them, Akansh "Dad... you lost again." His father looked at him and laughed. "I know." He picked up the plates and started walking toward the kitchen. "I know. Some battles aren't meant to be won, especially against the ones you love."

His mother smiled. Akansh watched them for a moment before smiling to himself. After helping carry a few dishes into the kitchen, Akansh picked up his phone. "Mom... Dad... I'm going for a walk." His mother looked up from her laptop. "Don't stay out too late." "I won't." His father. "Don't forget to bring ice cream." "I'll try," Akansh replied with a grin. He slipped on his shoes, stepped outside, and closed the front door behind him. The evening air was cool and refreshing. Streetlights illuminated the empty roads as he slowly walked toward the nearby park..His mind was still filled with questions. Why did the box open only for me? What is that green stone?.Why did nothing happen after I touched it?.Without realizing it, he had already reached the park. The place was peaceful.

Only the sound of leaves rustling in the gentle breeze could be heard. Akansh continued walking along the empty pathway. Then... A voice called out behind him. "Akansh." He stopped. He turned around. Standing beneath the glow of a streetlight was an elderly man with calm eyes and a smile.

The old man said "My name is Gaur..."